Meditation Lists

Five Daily Recollections:

Version 1

1. I am of the nature to grow old; I have not gotten beyond old age.
2. I am of the nature to become ill; I have not gotten beyond illness.
3. I am of the nature to die; I have not gotten beyond death.
4. All that is mine, dear and delightful, will change and vanish.
5. I am born of my karma; I will inherit my karma; whatever I do, whether good or evil, that I will inherit.

Version 2

1. I am of the nature to grow old. There is no way I can escape growing old. Instead of suppressing it, I invite it up and look directly at it.
2. I am of the nature to have ill health. There is no way to escape ill health.
3. I am of the nature to die. There is no way to escape death.
4. All that is dear to me and everyone I love are of the nature to change. There is no way to escape being separated from them.
5. My actions are my only true belongings. I cannot escape the consequences of my actions. My actions are the ground upon which I stand.

Five things to do at the start of a sitting:

1. Gratitude
2. Why am I doing this
3. Work up some determination
4. "Breathing in I calm body and mind, breathing out I smile."
5. Metta - always for yourself, others as well if you wish

Five things to do at the end of a sitting:

1. Recapitulation - what did I do and how did I get there
2. Impermanence - all these high, but mundane, states are now gone
3. Insights - did I get any; what were they
4. Dedicate the merit from this sitting for the liberation of all beings
5. Resolve to be mindful as I get up and go about my activities

Essence of entering each of the 8 Jhanas:

0. Follow breath until access concentration is established:

    a. Thoughts are wispy and in the background,
    b. and/or White light glows in the background,
    c. and/or Breath becomes very shallow or disappears.

1. Switch attention away from the breath to a pleasant physical sensation:

a. Stay focused on the 'pleasantness' of the pleasant sensation,
b. Do not do anything else but stay focused on the 'pleasantness', it will increase in intensity automatically.

2. Focus on the emotional joy/happiness that is accompanying the intense physical sensations of the 1st Jhana:

a. Push the the intense physical sensations into the background,
b. Stay one pointed on the joy/happiness.

3. Turn down the intensity of the joy/happiness to contentment/satisfaction.

4. Turn down the intensity of the contentment/satisfaction to a quiet, still equanimity.

5. Sense the "boundaries of your being" and begin pushing them outwards:

a. Push outwards until you fill the room,
b. Push outwards until you fill the building,
c. Push outwards until you fill the neighborhood,
d. Push outwards further and further, remain focused on pushing outwards,
e. When an infinite space opens up before you, switch your focus to it.

6. Realizing that it takes an infinite consciousness to be aware of an infinite space, switch your attention to to your consciousness of the infinite space.

7. Switch your attention from the infinite consciousness to the content of that consciousness - it will be an infinite emptiness - no-thing at all anywhere.

8. Let go of all the previous outward sensing and come to rest in a small spot more or less between the eyes and a few inches from your face.

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